COVER LETTER FOR SUBMISSION TO INFORMATION, COMMUNICATION & SOCIETY

Date: March 20, 2026

To:

Prof. Brian Loader and the Editorial Team

Information, Communication & Society (ICS)

Taylor & Francis Group

Subject: Submission of Original Research Manuscript for Double-Blind Peer Review

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Dear Professor Loader and Editorial Board Members,

We are pleased to submit our research manuscript entitled:

"Weaponized Emojis, Networked Contempt, and the Algorithmic Oracle: A Tri-Layer Forensic of Digital Public Resistance to Indonesia's Free Nutritious Meal Policy on Platform X"

for consideration as an Original Research Article in *Information, Communication & Society* (ICS).

Relevance to Information, Communication & Society

Information, Communication & Society stands at the forefront of critical inquiries into the social, economic, and political transformations shaped by digital platforms, networked affect, and algorithmic power.

Our paper investigates how the intersection of authoritarian content surveillance (e.g., Indonesia's UU ITE), digital platform affordances, and algorithmic actors transforms digital citizenship. Specifically, we examine the controversy surrounding Indonesia's national Free Nutritious Meal (Makan Bergizi Gratis / MBG) program on Platform X ($N = 9,862$ citizen posts).

Our study provides key contributions tailored to ICS readership:

1. **Everyday Forms of Digital Resistance & Semiotic Subversion:** Building on James C. Scott's weapons of the weak and Erving Goffman's framing, we theorize how citizens weaponize sarcasm and ironic emojis (,) as paralinguistic shields to voice political resistance against state policy failures without incurring legal liability.
2. Networked Affect & Echo Chamber Modularity: Drawing upon Zizi Papacharissi's networked affect, we demonstrate that citizen affective mobilization around MBG is characterized by severe fragmentation ($Q = 0.9837$ across 332 echo chambers) and near-total absence of deliberative engagement (reciprocity = 1.21%).
3. **The Rise of the Algorithmic Oracle:** We document an emergent form of algorithmic delegation where citizens query autonomous AI accounts (@grok) to bypass unresponsive state authorities, fundamentally reshaping the epistemic dynamics of the digital public sphere.

Empirical Rigor & Validation

- IndoBERT Transformer Architecture: Micro-affective Plutchik modeling achieving high throughput (223.3 posts/s) on Apple Silicon GPU.
- Inter-Rater Reliability Gold Standard: Adjudicated multi-annotator benchmark ($n = 100$) yielding inter-human agreement of 95.00% ($\kappa = 0.9135$), Tri-Rater Fleiss' Kappa $\kappa = 0.8442$, and Krippendorff's Alpha $\alpha = 0.8447$.
- **Taxonomic & Imbalance Robustness:** Resolving class imbalance artifacts via linguistic audit and hierarchical valence modeling (**Macro-F1 = 0.7522 / 75.22%**, Accuracy **76.56%**).
- Canonical Topology: Full reproducible network telemetry ($|V| = 971, |E| = 666$).

Compliance and Declarations

- **Originality:** The article is an original contribution, not previously published, and not concurrently under review elsewhere.
- **Double-Blind Review:** The submitted manuscript is fully blinded to preserve confidentiality.
- **Open Science:** Full datasets, code pipelines, and audit reports are archived at: https://github.com/indri007/ThisIsEconomy.
- **Publication Route:** We select the Standard Subscription (Zero APC / Free Publication) model.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely yours,

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